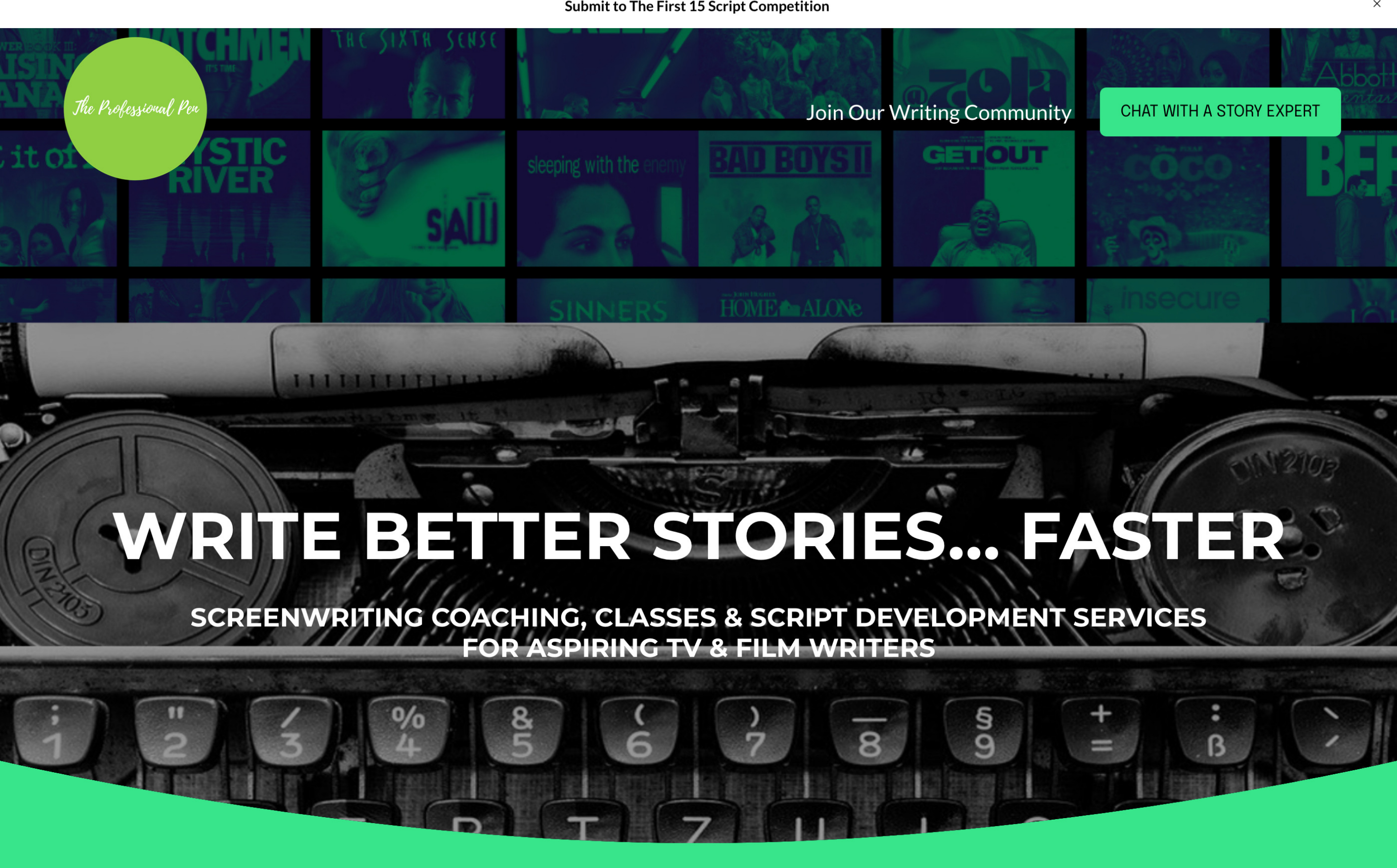


WRITE BETTER STORIES... FASTER

SCREENWRITING COACHING, CLASSES & SCRIPT DEVELOPMENT SERVICES FOR ASPIRING TV & FILM WRITERS

TRYING TO FIGURE OUT HOW TO WRITE A SCREENPLAY?

You need a plan.
The Professional Pen's 3-step path gives you the tools, feedback, and support to finally finish your script — and feel good about it.

STEP ONE

START WITH A PLAN

Have an idea but don't know how to start?
Use our digital screenwriting workbooks to shape your story into a clear roadmap from idea to script so the blank page never feels intimidating again.

WRITE YOUR STORY

STEP TWO

GET PROFESSIONAL SCRIPT NOTES

Finished a draft and wondering if it's ready?
Submit your script and receive honest, actionable, page-by-page Development Notes from your personal Story Expert trained to read like a studio executive.

IMPROVE YOUR SCRIPT

STEP THREE

CHAT 1: 1 WITH A STORY EXPERT

Feeling stuck or overwhelmed?
Book a Jam Session to talk through your story with a screenwriting coach. Together, we'll identify the problem, explore solutions, and create a clear path forward.

GET UNSTUCK

Still unsure where to start? Click here.

OUR CLIENTS ARE WINNING!

10 YEARS IN THE GAME

400 COMPETITION PLACEMENTS

85 WINNERS + FELLOWS

60 STAFFED + REPPED

25 DEVELOPED + SOLD

AND SO CAN YOU!

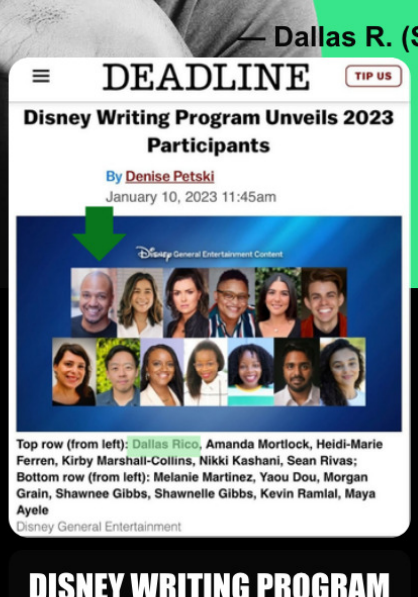
PEN PAL SUCCESS STORY

FROM STUCK ON THE REWRITE TO STAFFED WRITER.

"TPP gave me clear direction on what to do next."

— Dallas R. (Staffed Writer)

"I certainly plan to work with TPP again. Easily! I hired them for development notes. They blew my mind. I had been stuck on my script for over a month, trying to figure out the best way to revise it. TPP gave me clear direction on what to do next. They didn't just give me a list of things to change; they got to the heart of the issues with my script and revealed my blindspots. I felt like TPP was invested in my success. I left our meeting pumped to start revising. I can't wait to work with them again. Highly recommended."



DEADLINE

Disney Writing Program Unveils 2023 Participants

By Denise Petski
January 10, 2023 11:45am

Top row (from left): Dallas Rico, Amanda Mortlock, Heidi-Marie Ferren, Kirby Marshall-Collins, Nikki Kashani, Sean Rivas; Bottom row (from left): Melanie Martinez, Yaou Dou, Morgan Grain, Shawnee Gibbs, Shawnelle Gibbs, Kevin Ramlal, Maya Ayele

Disney General Entertainment

DISNEY WRITING PROGRAM
2023

REASONABLE DOUBT

STAFFED WRITER
REASONABLE DOUBT

DEADLINE

The Gotham Names 10 Series Creators To Watch At Inaugural TV Awards Ceremony

By Matt Grobar
June 4, 2024 5:00pm

Series Creators to Watch
the gotham WEEK

GOTHAM CREATORS TO WATCH
2024

WELCOME TO THE PROFESSIONAL PEN

Where screenwriting finally makes sense.

Hollywood is the largest gated community in the world — nepotism at its finest.
But at The Professional Pen (TPP), we're giving you the passcode.

Founded by former TV exec Shannan E. Johnson, TPP breaks the development process down into a 3-step journey that mirrors how it works in real studios —
but with way more support, way less confusion, and no gatekeeping.

Instead of one-size-fits-all script feedback, we assign you a dedicated screenwriting coach — a working writer trained to guide you from idea to pitch.
You'll get actionable script notes *and* a real plan for your rewrite, all tailored to you and your screenwriting goals.

You can safely throw the contradictory script coverage out of the window.

WITH TPP, YOU'LL LEARN TO:

THINK LIKE A PRO WRITER

WRITE SAMPLE SCRIPTS THAT OPEN DOORS

GET YOUR STORY PITCH-READY

AND WE'LL BE WITH YOU EVERY STEP OF THE WAY.

MEET YOUR SCREENWRITING COACHES

TPP IS FOR YOU IF...

- YOU ARE PASSIONATE ABOUT STORYTELLING
- YOU WANT TO BE A PROFESSIONAL SCREENWRITER.
- YOU FEEL STUCK IN YOUR WRITING
- YOU WANT TO LEARN SCREENWRITING
- YOU WANT ACCOUNTABILITY

TPP IS NOT FOR YOU IF...

- YOU'RE LOOKING FOR VALIDATION THROUGH SCRIPT COVERAGE.
- YOU'RE LOOKING FOR REPRESENTATION
- YOU'RE LOOKING FOR BUYERS, PRODUCERS, DIRECTORS, ETC.
- YOU AREN'T OPEN TO LEARNING
- YOU WANT US TO DO THE WRITING FOR YOU.

1. WRITE YOUR STORY

A screenwriting roadmap built for writers like you.

The **Idea to Script Starter Kit** gives you the play-by-play from FADE IN to THE END so you can finally finish your script and tell your story. **Perfect for beginners or anyone tired of staring at a blank page.**

Each Starter Kit Includes:

- Act Structure explained
- Creating compelling characters
- Plotting your story and emotional journey
- Outlining a screenplay
- Formatting a screenplay
- Beat Sheet + Outline templates and samples
- A screenwriting glossary
- 6-week Story Planner

Bonus: The Pixar Formula - RELOADED (Sample + Template)

Add-On Available: Instructional Video Buddies taught by our CEO + Head Consultant

TV Starter Kits Also Include:

- Writers' room organizational chart
- How to develop a TV series for the right network or streamer

LEARN MORE

Select your script format:

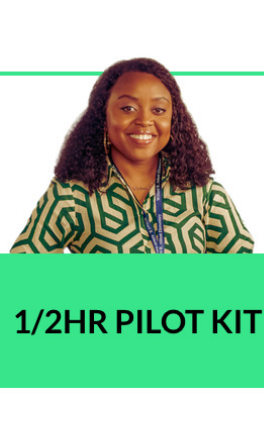
IDEA TO SCRIPT

1/2HR TV

For TV scripts that typically run 22–35 minutes and are often episodic, but include light serialization through ongoing relationships or themes.

Case Study Script - "Abbott Elementary" by Quinta Brunson

$69



1/2HR PILOT KIT

IDEA TO SCRIPT

1HR TV

For TV scripts that typically run 42–60 minutes and usually follow a serialized structure with ongoing character arcs and season-long storylines.

Case Study Script - "Scandal" by Shonda Rhimes

$69

1HR PILOT KIT

IDEA TO SCRIPT

FEATURES

For feature screenplays that typically run 90–120 minutes, depending on the genre, and delivers a complete emotional and narrative arc by the end.

Case Study Script - BLACK PANTHER by Ryan Coogler + Joe Robert Cole

$59

FEATURE KIT

2. SUBMIT YOUR SCRIPT

Development Notes is our signature service.

Get studio-level notes from a Story Expert — trained and hand-picked — who will break down your script's strengths, challenges, and next steps so you can rewrite with clarity and confidence. **Perfect for screenwriters ready to take their script from "done" to "pitch-ready."**

You'll Receive:

- Detailed page-by-page notes on:
  - Story
  - Structure
  - Character
  - Areas of Confusion

Plus:

- Overall summary of areas of development
- Final recommendation: Pass / Needs Development / Consider
- Clear next steps

What To Expect:

- Turnaround: 14 business days
- Additional pages: $4/pg.
- Pay Later Available

Continue Your Development:

- Logline Review
- Story Jam
- Rewrite Package
- Discount on future drafts

LEARN MORE

Writing a short? Short films are workshopped through a Story Jam instead of Development Notes. Book a Story Jam.

SELECT YOUR SCRIPT FORMAT:

1/2HR TV

For pilot scripts up to 30 pgs.

$139

SUBMIT 1/2HR TV

1HR TV

For pilot scripts up to 60 pgs.

$259

SUBMIT 1HR TV

FEATURES

For feature scripts up to 120 pgs.

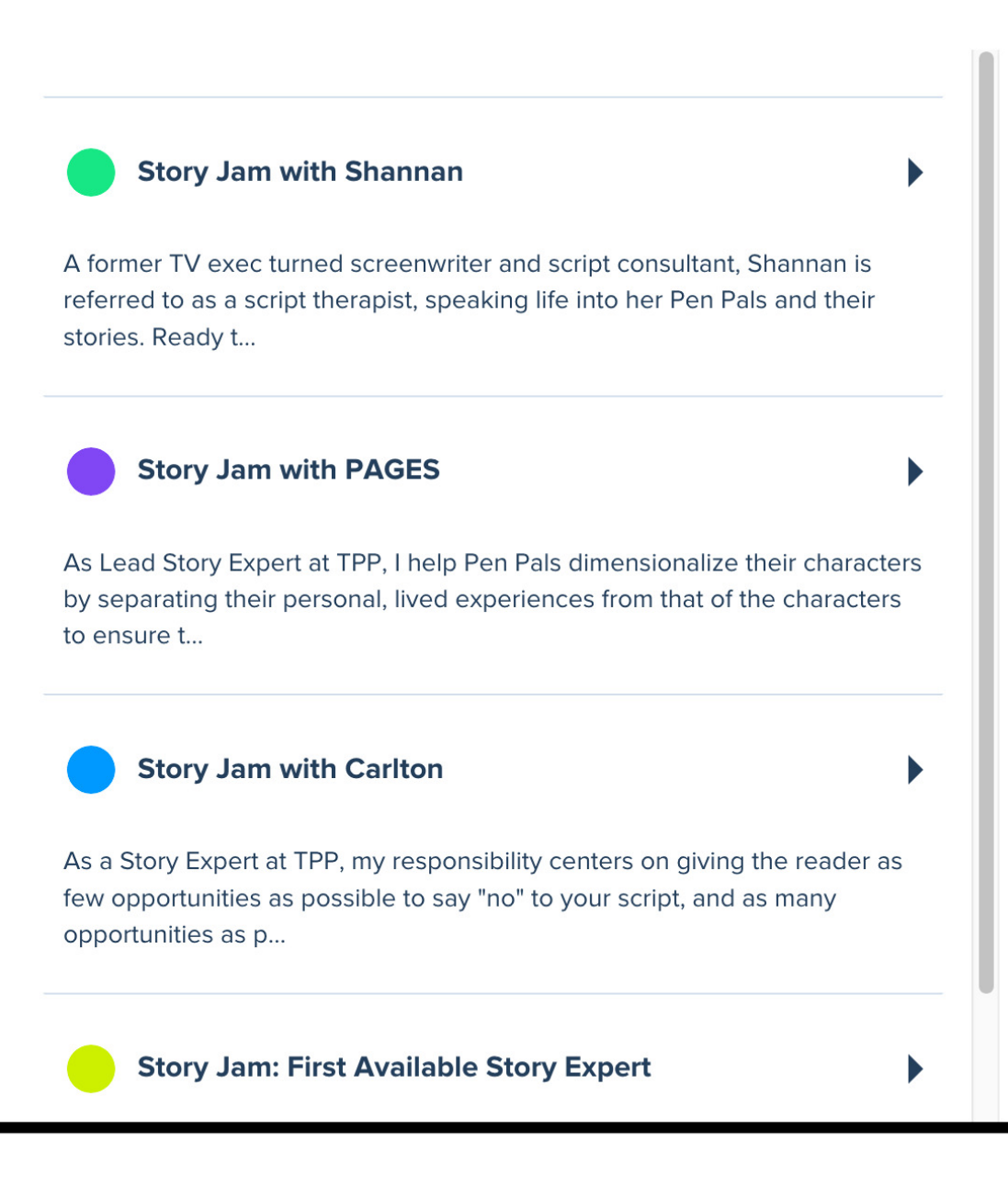
$379

SUBMIT FEATURE

3. BOOK A CONSULTATION

Talk story with your personal Story Expert

We call them Story Jams — your time, your way. Use it to clarify notes, work through story problems, even brainstorm a brand-new idea, prepare to pitch, or workshop a short to prepare for production. It's a live, 1:1 session designed to get you unstuck and moving forward with confidence. **Perfect for writers who want personal attention and accountability.**



Story Jam with Shannan

A former TV exec turned screenwriter and script consultant, Shannan is referred to as a script therapist, speaking life into her Pen Pals and their stories. Ready t...

Story Jam with PAGES

As Lead Story Expert at TPP, I help Pen Pals dimensionalize their characters by separating their personal, lived experiences from that of the characters to ensure t...

Story Jam with Carlton

As a Story Expert at TPP, my responsibility centers on giving the reader as few opportunities as possible to say "no" to your script, and as many opportunities as p...

Story Jam: First Available Story Expert

STILL UNSURE WHERE TO START?

No worries. We'll figure it out together.

Book a 15-min chat with us, and we'll make a plan for your screenwriting journey.

CHAT WITH A STORY EXPERT

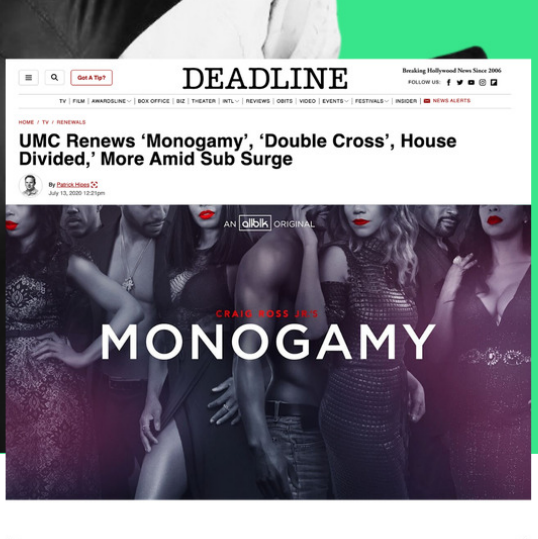
PEN PAL SUCCESS STORY

THE WRITERS BEHIND MONOGAMY TRUST TPP.

"I won't make a move without TPP's services. Yes. They're THAT good."

— Craig R. (Showrunner) and Caryn W.R. (Actress + Producer)

"The Professional Pen is by FAR one of the BEST script consulting services available to writers at every level. They are so highly skilled and knowledgeable about story and script development, and bring their passion and intuition to the table. What they have simply can't be taught. I'm so grateful to have come across their work as they have helped me elevate my screenplays for producers. I won't make a move without TPP's services. Yes. They're THAT good."

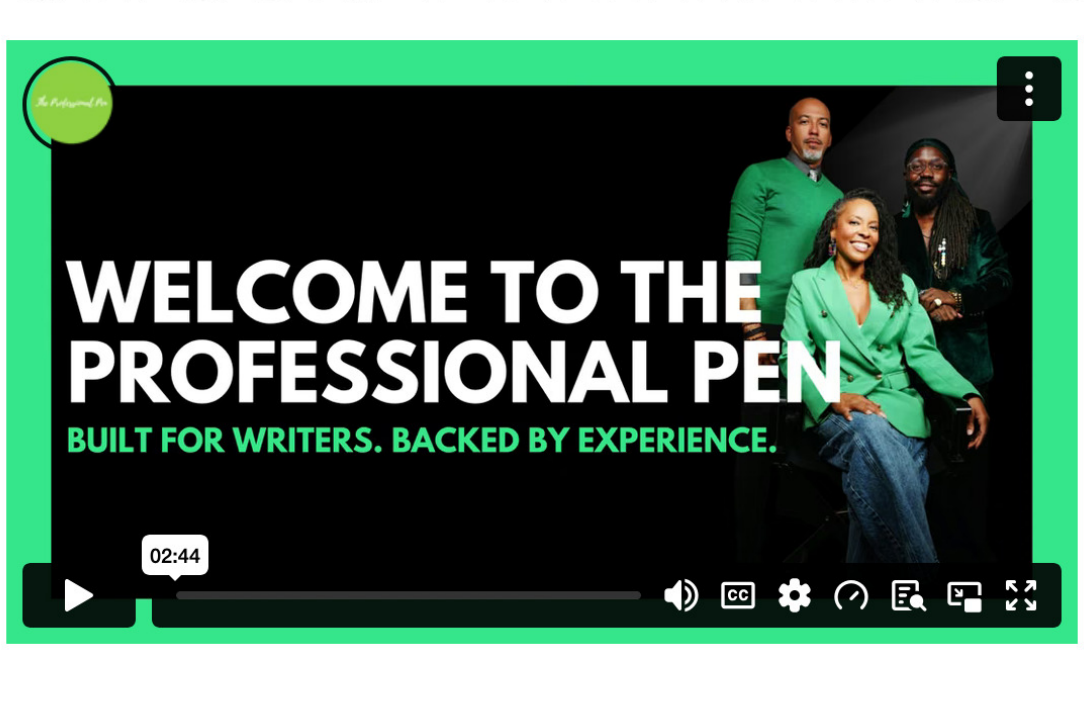


DEADLINE

UMC Renews 'Monogamy', 'Double Cross', House Divided,' More Amid Sub Surge

CRAIG ROSS JR.'S MONOGAMY
SERIES RENEWAL

MEET YOUR SCREENWRITING COACHES



WELCOME TO THE PROFESSIONAL PEN
BUILT FOR WRITERS. BACKED BY EXPERIENCE.
02:44

Sold writer and multi-fellowship alum, PAGES (They/He) is a genderqueer med-school dropout turned award-winning film-poet and agent of imagination, writing poems and high-concept dramas centering stubborn characters and stories of defying the odds through their Black, Queer, and immigrant perspective.

They are a National Poetry Slam and Southern Fried Champion, a GLAAD Black Queer Creatives Fellow, a Callaloo Fellow at Brown University, and the author of three books, including "The Heart of Comet (Write Bloody)." Their work is fueled by Toni Morrison's words: *"The function of freedom is to free someone else."* They have also been featured by TEDx, Macy's, the Apollo, Essence, and KeyTV by Keke Palmer, among many other platforms. Their short film, SEVEN MINUTES OF HEAVEN?, produced by SuperSpecial, earned multiple laurels on the festival circuit.

When they're not fiercely working on their next screenplay or poetry manuscript, they practice trauma-informed work as a teaching artist in Los Angeles (Tongva Land). They are a full-time artist, performer, and organizer who loves gummy bears, fried plantains, and battle-horror anime

Highlighted Accomplishments: 1hr fantasy TV drama (EP Lily Wachowski (THE MATRIX)) in development with ITV & Anarchists United, Circle of Confusion Writers Discovery fellow, John Singleton x PAFF short film prize finalist, CANNES Diversity Showcase

Fun Facts:
Hometown: Born and raised in Cameroon, Central Africa then blossomed in the DMV

lvin McCraney's
ook Blue
tten by Daniel
based on "The

Dodge, Jeep, RAM, FIAT and Toyota

Fun Facts:
Hometown: Los Angeles, CA
Favorite Film: ETERNAL SUNSHINE OF THE SPOTLESS MIND written by Charlie Kauffman
Favorite Screenplay: BLACK PANTHER written by Joe Robert Cole & Ryan Coogler based on the Marvel Comics by Jack Kirby and Stan Lee
Favorite Series: "The Big Bang Theory" created by Chuck Lorre and Bill Prady

WRITE WITH US

You don't need an expensive film school degree. You need the tools Hollywood actually uses.

The Professional Pen's Academy gives writers the tools, training, and guidance you need to build a real story foundation without the film-school price tag.

Clear lessons. Live meetings. Professional feedback. A direct path from idea to pitch.

Whether you're learning at your own pace or joining our live 6-week course, The Academy makes industry-level storytelling accessible — and affordable.

LEARN MORE

WELCOME TO THE SOCIAL: WHERE SCREENWRITERS HANG
THE STUDENT LOUNGE + SCREENING ROOM:
THE ACADEMY
SMART
SPECIFIC
MEASURABLE
ACTIONABLE
REALISTIC

OOD HOLLYWOOD

THEY MADE IT. NOW, IT'S YOUR TURN.

These working writers didn't wait to be discovered.
They built, pitched, and developed their way in.
You can too—with the right game plan. We gotchu.

START YOUR SCREENWRITING JOURNEY

THE PROFESSIONAL PEN

Work with Shannan
SCREENWRITING SERVICES:
Outline Review
Development Notes
Story Notes
SCREENWRITING CONSULTATIONS:
Story Jam
Kick-Off Jam
Work with Shannan
COMPANY:
About
Meet the Coaches
FAQ's
Policies + Agreement

EDUCATIONAL RESOURCES:
Screenwriting Workbooks
Screenwriting Courses
Screenwriting Community
The Screenwriting Blog
SCREENWRITING PROGRAMS:
The First 15 Script Competition
The Executive Training Program

CONNECT:

SUBSCRIBE

Sign up with your email address to receive news and updates.

Email Address

SIGN UP

We respect your privacy.